```
$ mysqldump -u $UserName -p $DatabaseName > dump.sql
```

And, of course, you can export a database over a network connection as follows. To connect to a server to export a database, replace `$Host` with the host name or IP address of your database:

```
$ mysqldump -u $UserName -p $DatabaseName --host $Host > dump.sql
```

See the MySQL documentation if you need more information about the `mysqldump` tool.

Theoretically, you could import a database to RDS from any machine from your on-premises or local network, but the higher latency over the internet or VPN connection will slow down the import process dramatically. Because of this, we recommend adding a second step: upload the database dump to a virtual machine running in the same AWS region and VPC, and import the database into RDS from there.

AWS Database Migration Service

When migrating a huge database to AWS with minimal downtime, the Database Migration Service (DMS) can help. We do not cover DMS in this book, but you can learn more on the AWS website: https://aws.amazon.com/dms.

To do so, we'll guide you through the following steps:

1. Connect to the virtual machine that is running WordPress.
2. Download a database dump from S3 to the VM. (If you are using your own database dump, we recommend uploading it to S3 first.)